

Antimicrobial textile competitors — landscape & talent sourcing

The companies selling antimicrobial textile treatments, mapped for two purposes: (1) building friendly working relationships with people in the field, and (2) sourcing **former** employees with real field experience to recruit as FUZE contract / commission sales. Company facts and LinkedIn pages are verified; the companion spreadsheet holds copy-paste search strings and an outreach tracker.

THE COMPETITOR FIELD

COMPANY	PRODUCT / BRAND	CHEMISTRY	HQ	LINKEDIN	RECRUIT
Microban International	Microban® (AEGIS heritage)	Silver / zinc / Si-QAC	Huntersville, NC	/company/microban-international	#1
LANXESS — Silvadur	SILVADUR™	Silver-ion	Cologne, DE · LA + WV (US)	/company/lanxess	#2
Sciescent LLC	Agion® / Agion Active / Lava	Silver-zeolite	Beverly, MA	/company/sciescent	#3
Polygiene Group AB	Stays Fresh / ViralOff	Silver chloride	Malmö, SE	/company/polygiene-ab	—
Sanitized AG	Sanitized®	Silver / Zn-pyr / Si-QAC	Burgdorf, CH	/company/sanitized-ag	—
HeiQ	Viroblock / Synbio / Fresh	Silver / silver-vesicle	Schlieren, CH	/company/heiq	—
Thomson / Ultra-Fresh	Ultra-Fresh® / Silpure	Silver / Zn-pyrrhione	Toronto, CA	/company/thomson-research-associates	—
Rudolf Group	RUCO-BAC, SILVERPLUS	Silver chloride / Ag-Ru	Geretsried, DE	/company/rudolf-group	—

Note: **Microban and Ultra-Fresh / Thomson are now one ownership group** (W.M. Barr / Barr Brands Intl) — one combined US talent ecosystem centered in Huntersville, NC. **Silvadur lineage:** Dow → IFF → LANXESS (2022) — anyone with "Dow Microbial Control" or "IFF Microbial Control" history maps to today's Silvadur team.

BEST ALUMNI RECRUITING TARGETS (US FIELD TALENT)

#1 · MICROBAN (+ ULTRA-FRESH)

Deepest US pool

US-HQ antimicrobial company (~153) with US-based textile sales, BD and technical-service teams. Now also umbrellas Ultra-Fresh's people.

#2 · LANXESS / SILVADUR

Ex-Dow/IFF bench

Inherited the former Dow/IFF Microbial Control team with US technical + field staff (Louisiana, West Virginia) and a US commercial org.

#3 · SCIESSENT (AGION)

100% US & textile

Small (~28–50) but entirely US-based and fully antimicrobial-textile focused — every commercial/technical person is an on-target, US-resident prospect.

HOW TO WORK IT

Two motions, kept distinct. (1) **Network** with people currently in the field — warm, no-agenda connections that build a friendly presence in the industry. (2) **Recruit former employees** — people who've left these companies and carry the mill/brand relationships and application know-how, for FUZE contract/commission sales (same model as our existing BD reps). We target *former* employees for recruiting — not active poaching of current staff.

TEMPLATE A · FRIENDLY LINKEDIN CONNECTION (CURRENT INDUSTRY PEOPLE)

"Hi [First] — I'm on the FUZE side of antimicrobial textiles and have followed [Company]'s work in the space. Always glad to connect with people who know this corner of the industry well — no agenda, happy to trade notes anytime. — Andrew, FUZE Biotech"

TEMPLATE B · RECRUITING A FORMER EMPLOYEE (CONTRACT / COMMISSION SALES)

"Hi [First] — your antimicrobial-textile background at [Company] is exactly the field experience that's hard to find. I'm Andrew, founder of FUZE Biotech — we make the only non-leaching antimicrobial metamaterial (sole-source, 58 patents, already in testing with Nike, Patagonia, Spanx, SanMar and others). We're expanding our field network and work with experienced reps on a contract / commission basis — you'd sell into mills and brands you already know. Worth a 15-minute call to see if it fits? Either way, glad to connect."

● FINDING THE PEOPLE (NO PAID TOOLS)

Use a **Google X-ray search** to surface profiles — it catches both current and former employees because profiles list past roles.

Example for Sciessent:

```
site:linkedin.com/in ("Sciessent" OR "Agion") ("technical sales" OR "business development" OR "technical service" OR application OR "account manager") (textile OR apparel OR antimicrobial)
```

For **former employees only**, use LinkedIn People search and set the "**Past company**" filter (leave "Current company" blank). The companion spreadsheet has a ready X-ray string for all eight companies plus an outreach tracker.

Bottom line: Microban (+ Ultra-Fresh), LANXESS/Silvadur, and Sciessent hold the deepest US-based antimicrobial-textile field talent. Build friendly industry relationships broadly; recruit their alumni — who already own the mill and brand relationships — as FUZE contract reps. The spreadsheet is your working list.